



THE RISE OF NAZI GERMANY: 1918-1945

Revision Notes for Modern World History GCSE
and IGCSE Specifications

[Using this Revision Booklet](#)

Knowing and understanding the key events and facts from each topic is essential for success at GCSE and IGCSE. Many exam questions require the use of detailed and specific factual knowledge to support the claims you make. Make sure you study the following list of key events and changes as part of your revision. Use the revision checklist and diagrams at the back of the book to help you keep track of your revision as you go - and don't forget to check out mrbuddhistory.com for more revision resources.

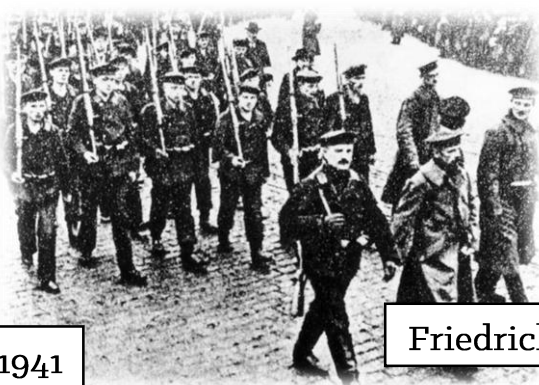
By Mr. Budd @ www.mrbuddhistory.com

1.) The German Revolution: 29th Oct – 11th Nov 1918

Who?	Causes	What happened?	Consequences
Germany led by Kaiser Wilhelm II The Social Democrat Party (SPD) led by Friedrich Ebert.	The War situation had changed: Germany was close to defeat by Autumn 1918. The German 'Spring Offensive' of March 1918 had failed. In July, the Allies counter-attacked across the Western Front, driving the Germans back towards Germany. 2 million German soldiers had died since 1914 and morale was at breaking point. Hardship within Germany. The Allied naval blockade had limited the imports of basic supplies. Food shortages led to the deaths of 424,000 civilians and a further 200,000 died from an outbreak of deadly influenza in August 1918. The pressure for political change was growing. Russian Revolution of November 1917 had increased the pressure for change, particular from Communist groups.	On 29th October, German sailors at the naval base of Wilhelmshaven refused to follow orders to set sail in one last suicidal attack on the British navy. By 4th November, the mutiny had spread to Kiel naval base where 40,000 sailors and dockers set up a workers' and soldiers' council and took over the dockyard. Similar revolts took place across Germany in towns like Hamburg, Bremen and Lubeck. On 7th November, in the state of Bavaria, thousands of workers led by Kurt Eisner, marched on Munich and overthrew the Bavarian monarchy of King Ludwig III and set-up a free-state and republic. On 9th November, due to pressure from his own ministers and the Allies who said they would only negotiate with 'representatives of the people', Kaiser Wilhelm II abdicated, fleeing to Holland. The Social Democrat Party (SPD) formed a new temporary government led by Friedrich Ebert, who became the new Chancellor.	Short-Term: On 11th November, the new government agreed an armistice with the Allies, ending WW1. Germany had to withdraw from all land won in the war, pull troops back 30 miles inside its border with France, surrender its munitions and put its navy under Allied control. Medium-Term: Terms of the armistice were not popular and economic suffering continued, mainly due to the Allied Naval Blockade of Germany which continued until June 1919. This also resulted in political turmoil throughout the winter of 1918-19. Medium-Term: The Revolution and abdication of the Kaiser eventually led to the formation of a new German State and democratic system – the Weimar Republic. Long-Term: the new government would continually suffer from criticism and protest for forcing the Kaiser to abdicate (November Criminals) and agreeing to end the war prematurely.



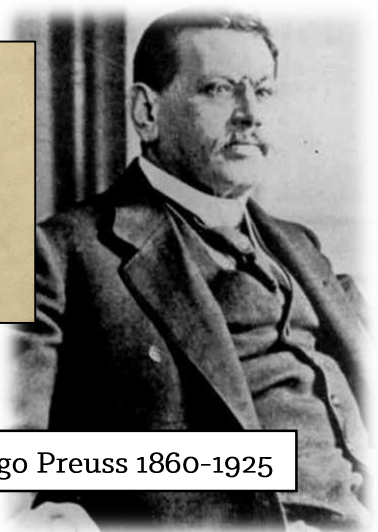
Kaiser Wilhelm II 1871-1941



Friedrich Ebert 1871-1925

2.) The Weimar Constitution: Feb - Aug 1919

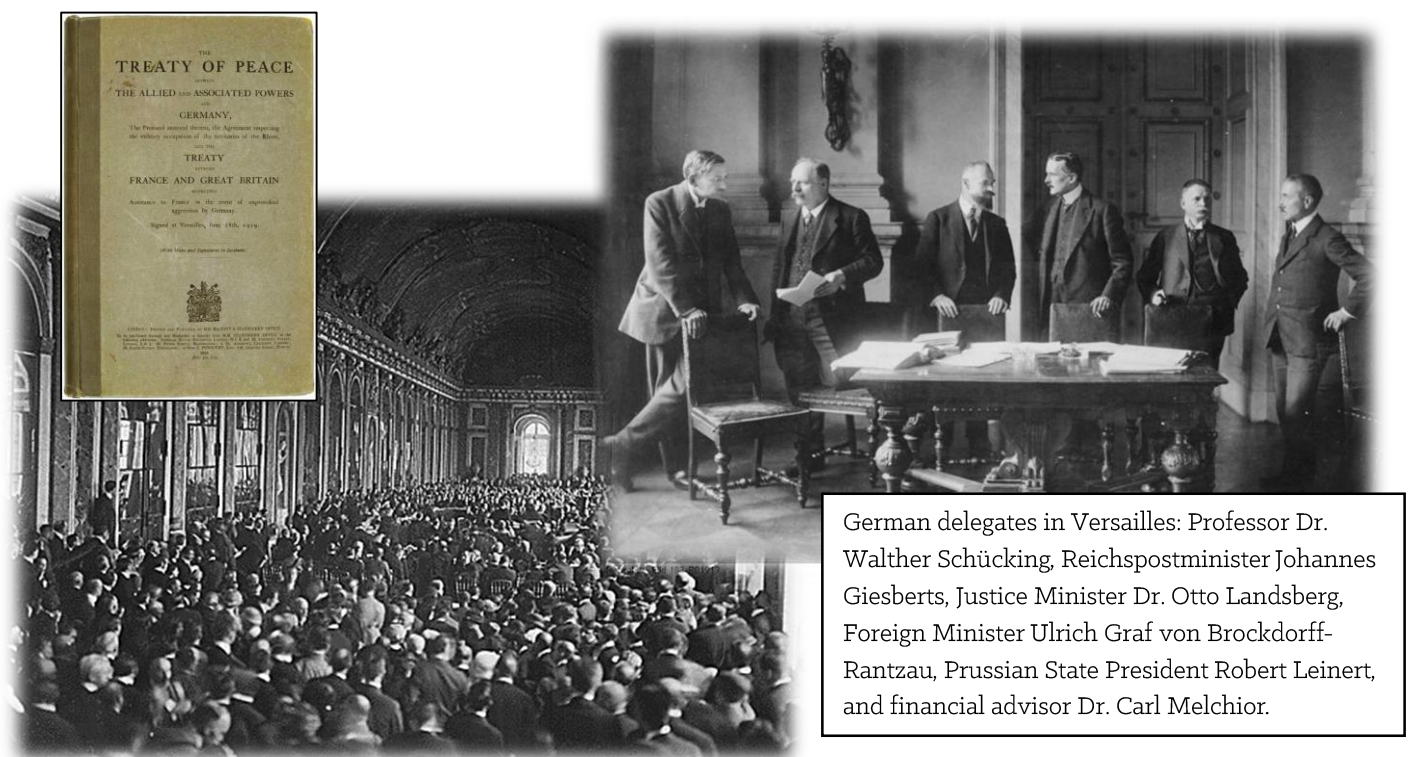
Causes	Terms	Strengths/Weaknesses	Consequence
The temporary government of 'the Council of People's Deputies' was not a long-term solution to the problem of government so they organised elections for a National Assembly on 19th Jan 1919. This met in February to create a new constitution. They gathered in the National Theatre in the town of Weimar, in the state of Thuringia on 6th Feb due to the Spartacist Uprising in Berlin. The Constitution was drafted by the lawyer and liberal politician Hugo Preuss. The Constitution was signed into law by President Ebert on 11th August 1919.	Local government was run by 18 regions of Germany which kept local parliaments. Central government given more power. Reichstag became dominant house of the new German parliament and controlled taxation. - Members of Reichstag elected every 4 years. - All men and women over 20 years could vote. Proportional Representation was used for elections. The Reichrat became the upper house of the German parliament. - Members were sent by each local region. - Could delay laws unless overruled by 2/3 majority of the Reichstag. The chancellor was the head of the government who chose ministers and ran the country. Needed majority support in Reichstag to pass laws. The President was head of state and directly elected every 7 years. - President took no part in day-to-day government. - Chose the chancellor - Could dismiss the Reichstag, call new election and control the army. - Under Article 48, he could suspend the constitution and pass laws by decree.	Strengths Made Germany more democratic than it had been under the Kaiser. More people voted and there was a general election every 4 years. Also introduced checks and balances to make government fairer. Two houses in the new parliament: the power of the Reichstag was limited by the power of the Reichrat. Power was also shared between the Chancellor and the President. No single group all person had all the power. Weaknesses Proportional Representation meant that even a party with a small number of votes gained seats in the Reichstag, increasing instability of government. To get majority support for new laws, chancellors needed coalitions of several parties. Parties often couldn't agree. Balance of powers in constitution meant that strong, decisive government by the chancellor was very difficult in times of crisis.	Short-Term: Friedrich Ebert was elected as the first President of the Weimar Republic. Long-Term: Extremist parties didn't support the constitution and moderate Germans feared it was too weak, leading to the growth in popularity of extremist parties like the Communists or far-right. Long-Term: Chancellors often had to ask the President to suspend the constitution under Article 48 whenever compromise broke down. This gave the impression that the new constitution didn't really work and was weak – further increasing political instability. Long-Term: Proportional Representation meant that even small political parties could have a say in government. This weakened the support for moderate centre-parties like the SPD as people had too much voting choice.



Hugo Preuss 1860-1925

3.) The Treaty of Versailles: 28th June 1919

Who?	Causes	Terms	Consequences
UK led by David Lloyd George France led by Georges Clemenceau USA led by Woodrow Wilson Italy led by Vittorio Orlando	The Allied victors of WW1 met at The Paris Peace Conference of 18th January 1919 – 21st January 1920 to decide the fate of Germany. The Treaty of Versailles was the result of these negotiations and was shaped mainly by the French <u>desire to punish Germany</u>.	War Guilt – Article 231 became known as the 'War Guilt Clause' as Germany had to accept blame for starting the war. Reparations – Germany had to pay reparations to the Allies. They were fixed in 1921 at 136,000 million marks or £6600 million. Colonies – German lost all its 11 colonies in Africa and the Far East and were given as 'mandates' for the Allies to look after. Military – German army limited to 100,000, Navy limited to 6 battleships, 6 Cruisers, 12 destroyers and 12 torpedo boats. No submarines allowed. No airforce allowed. Rhineland was demilitarised. Land – Alsace and Lorraine lost to France, Eupen Malmedy lost to Belgium, Posen and West Prussia lost to Poland, Plebiscites had to take place in Upper Silesia which voted to become part of Poland and Northern Schleswig which went to Denmark. Port of Danzig became international city. Germany lost 13% of land it total and 50% of iron reserves and 15% of its coal reserves.	Stirred up political protest – Germany was given 15 days to sign the Treaty and was allowed no say in its final provisions. The Treaty became known as the 'diktat' as Germany had no choice but to sign. This angered many political groups in Germany. Weakened the popularity of the Weimar Republic – many people believed the army had not been defeated and could have fought on so they blamed the Weimar Politicians for signing the Treaty. The army had been 'stabbed in the back' (Dolchstoß) by the 'November Criminals'. Harmed Germany's economy – the extraordinarily high reparations figure put a huge burden on the German economy. Germany's ability to pay this back was further hampered by its loss of resource rich lands which led to high inflation.



German delegates in Versailles: Professor Dr. Walther Schücking, Reichspostminister Johannes Giesberts, Justice Minister Dr. Otto Landsberg, Foreign Minister Ulrich Graf von Brockdorff-Rantzau, Prussian State President Robert Leinert, and financial advisor Dr. Carl Melchior.



Map showing territory lost by Germany from the Treaty of Versailles.



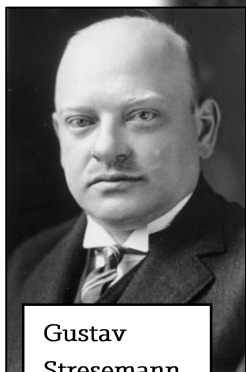
A 1924 right-wing German cartoon showing the SPD politician **Philipp Scheidemann** who proclaimed the Weimar Republic and its second Chancellor, **Matthias Erzberger**, who signed the armistice with the Allies ending WW1. Both are show 'stabbing the German Army in the back'.

An Austrian illustration from 1919 showing the German Army being 'stabbed in the back' by a caricatured Jew. Along with Weimar Politicians, Socialists and Communists, Jews were also blamed for Germany's defeat in the First World War.

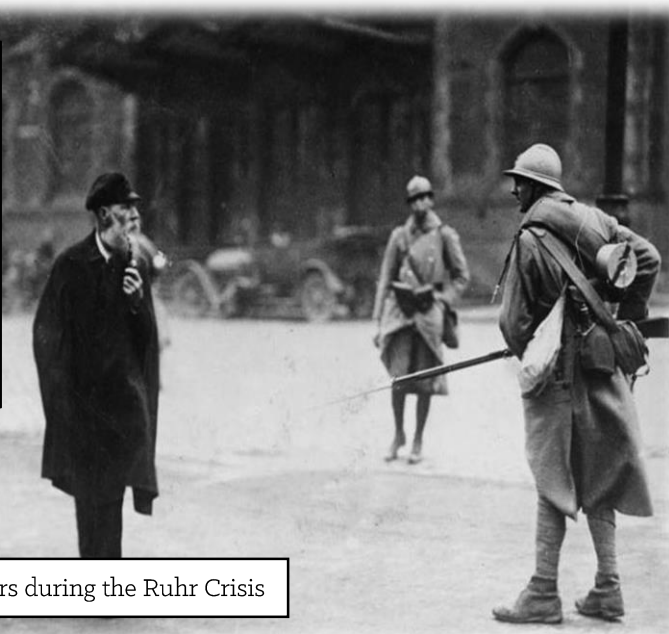


4.) The Ruhr Crisis and Hyperinflation: 1918 – 1923

Causes	What happened?	Consequences
The German government was bankrupt as its reserves of gold had all been spent in the war. The Treaty of Versailles made things worse by depriving Germany of resource-rich areas like the coalfields of Silesia. Reparations repayments further harmed the German economy. By 1923, Germany couldn't afford the repayments.	In retaliation for the failure to repay reparations, the French and Belgians sent 750,000 troops into the German industrial area of the Ruhr. They confiscated raw materials, manufactured goods and industrial machinery. The German government urged passive resistance and workers went on strike. 80% of German coal and iron was based in the Ruhr, so whilst the occupation did the French little good, Germany was crippled. The disruption increased Germany's debts, unemployment and the shortage of goods. Shortages meant that the price of things went up (inflation). The government needed money to pay debts but unemployment and failing factories meant they received less money from taxes. The government responded by just printing money, using over 300 paper mills and 2000 printing shops in 1923! Printing money just made inflation worse. More money was then printed and a vicious circle had been created and hyperinflation caused bread to rise from 1 mark in 1919 to 100,000 marks in 1923. Thing only improved when Gustav Stresemann was appointed Chancellor in September 1923. By November, he cancelled the old mark and issued a new currency – the Rentenmark. This stabilised the economy.	<u>Benefits</u> Farmers profited from rising food prices and some businesses were able to pay off loans, as the loans lost value. Others were able to buy up smaller, failing businesses very cheaply. <u>Costs</u> Everyone suffered from shortages – German marks became worthless compared to foreign currency. Foreign suppliers refused to accept marks for goods, so imports dried up and food shortages got worse! Difficult to buy what was needed – people had to carry wheelbarrows full of money. Workers were paid twice a day so they could rush out and buy goods before prices rose further. Some resorted to trading goods instead of money. Savings wiped out – those with savings, insurance policies and pensions were hit hardest as saving became worthless. Those affected were mainly middle class.



Gustav Stresemann
1878-1929



French soldiers during the Ruhr Crisis



Worthless currency in 1929

5.) Spartacist Uprising and Kapp Putsch: 1918-1923

Causes	What happened?	Consequences
Right-wing Parties – resented that the ‘November Criminals’; hated and feared the communists, wanted to reverse Versailles, reinstate the Kaiser, boost the army and return Germany to its former strength. Had the support of the military, judiciary and civil service. Left-wing Parties – like the Communists (KPD) wanted a socialist revolution like in Russia; thought that Weimar gave too little power to the workers; wanted government by Soviet councils, wanted to abolish the land-owning classes and the army. Unpopularity of new Weimar Government – Between 1918-23, German people hated the Weimar leaders’ decision to admit defeat in 1918, hated the Versailles Treaty for its guilt placed on Germany and hated the hardships caused by unemployment and inflation. Everyone blamed the government and looked to more extreme methods to replace it. Private Armies – many political parties had their own private armies which caused political activity to become violent. There were 376 political murders between 1919-22, mostly of left-wing or moderate politicians. Not a single right-wing murderer was convicted, angering the left-wing.	<u>Spartacist Uprising</u> On 6th January 1919, 100,000 communists demonstrated in Berlin and took over key buildings such as newspaper offices. The communists were inspired by the Spartacist League led by Karl Liebknecht and Rosa Luxemburg. Chancellor Ebert and his defence minister, Gustav Noske, persuaded the 250,000 strong Freikorps (demobilised soldiers who had refused to give back their weapons) to put down the Spartacist uprisings. Thousands of communists were arrested or killed, mostly in Berlin. Rosa Luxemburg and Karl Liebknecht were arrested on 15th January and were murdered by the Freikorps. The threat from the left was over. <u>Kapp Putsch</u> In March 1920, elements of the Freikorps and military supporters of Dr. Wolfgang Kapp marched on Berlin to overthrow the Weimar Republic and bring back the Kaiser. On the evening of 12th March, they took over the government quarter of the city. President Ebert and the government fled to Dresden on 13th March, urging German workers not to co-operate but go on strike. Up to 12 million workers responded to the call and refused to work. The gas, electricity, water and transport all stopped in Berlin. Kapp realised he could not govern and fled to Sweden.	Government popularity and authority was weakened – the government had not been able to govern on its own authority. It relied on workers’ strikes and the Freikorps to defeat political opponents. In the following elections of 6th June 1920, the SPD (Ebert’s Party) fell by over half compared to the January 1919 elections. Extremist Parties gathered strength – the two uprisings proved that the government was weak and those who have the most military power could eventually win. This increased unrest throughout Germany, leading to the Munich Putsch in 1923.



Rosa Luxemburg 1871-1919



Karl Liebknecht 1871-1919



Wolfgang Kapp
1858-1922

6.) The Stresemann Era: 1924-1929

Policy	Causes	What happened?	Consequences
The Rentenmark Oct 1923	The biggest problem Germany faced in 1923 was hyperinflation caused by the Ruhr Crisis. Something had to be done to stabilise the economy.	Old currency was abolished and a new, temporary currency was introduced, the Rentenmark. New notes were trusted because the government promised to exchange them for shares in land or industry if the currency failed. In Aug 1924, the Rentenmark was replaced by a new permanent currency called the Reichsmark. A new independent national bank, the Reichsbank, was also created to control the currency.	Confidence in the currency, banking system and economy was restored. Deposits in German banks rose from 900m marks at the start of 1924 to 4,900 marks at the end of 1926.
The Dawes Plan April 1924	Reparations payments were set so high that Germany had been unable to pay in 1923, leading to the Ruhr Crisis . The Allies needed to be persuaded to reduce them to a sensible level. Allied troops were still occupying the Ruhr and needed to be removed.	<u>Stresemann and the Allies agreed to:</u> 1.) Reduce annual payments to an affordable level. 2.) The USA promised to provide \$800 million in loans to German Industry to promote economic growth. 3.) The Ruhr area would be evacuated by Allied occupation troops as soon as reparations payments restarted.	Short-Term Economic Benefits – the German economy recovered and received increased foreign investment and loans. Coal output rose from 275 million tons in 1924 to 350 million tons in 1929. Manufactured goods sales doubled 1923-29 and unemployment fell in 1928 to its lowest for 10 years. Long-Term Economic Problems – the Plan made the German economy dependent on the US economy which suffered greatly during the 1929 Great Depression.
The Locarno Pact October 1925	Germany was treated unfairly by the Allies and Stresemann needed some success in international diplomacy to appease German demands.	Germany signed the Locarno agreement with Britain, France, Italy and Belgium. Germany agreed to keep to its new 1919 border with France and Belgium . In return, the Allies agreed to remove their troops from the Rhineland and discuss German entry to the League of Nations.	Germany treated as an equal – the ‘spirit of Locarno’ improved relations in Europe in the 1925-1930 period, encouraging foreign investment to German.
The League of Nations 1926	Germany was excluded from joining the League of Nations when it was created by the ToV in 1919. The Locarno Pact paved the way for Germany’s remittance.	Stresemann persuaded the League to accept Germany as a member in 1926 and Germany even gained a place on the League’s Council. Hitler would eventually leave the League in October 1933.	Germany was trusted again and treated as an equal in world affairs, helping Germany’s ability to gain financial and diplomatic help from the Allied powers.
Kellogg-Briand Pact August 1928	Stresemann was keen to prove Germany’s commitment to international peace, some say as a way to persuade the Allies to drop the terms of the ToV.	Germany was one of 65 countries to sign the Kellogg-Briand Pact – an international agreement by which states promised not to use war to achieve their foreign policy aims.	This also showed that Germany had become a respectable member of the international community which led to the international community’s willingness to sign the Young Plan of 1929.
The Young Plan August 1929	Success in foreign policy eventually led to success in economic policy.	The Young Plan cut reparations payments from £6.6 billion to £2 billion, with 59 more years to pay.	The Plan strengthened the Weimar Republic by easing the burden of reparations payments however Germans like Adolf Hitler criticised Stresemann for ‘passing on the penalty to the unborn’.

7.) Creation of the Nazi Party: 1919-1923

Causes	How did Hitler help the party grow?	Consequences
During WW1, Adolf Hitler had been a corporal in the German army and had been awarded the Iron Cross. After the war, Hitler worked for the Army, spying on political groups in Munich. One was the German Workers' Party (DAP) which was founded by Anton Drexler on 9th January 1919. He joined the party in Sep 1919. The DAP was angry about: communists and socialists for bringing down the Kaiser; Weimer politicians for signing the ToV; the weakness of Democracy and the Jews who they blamed for weakening the economy. In this sense, the creation of the Nazi Party was a response to the problems in Germany caused by the German revolution.	By 1920, Hitler was working as Drexler's right-hand man and in February 1920, the two men revealed the new 25-Point Programme of the DAP. It called for 1.) Scrapping the ToV; 2.) Expanding Germany's borders to give its people lebensraum (more land to live in); 3.) Depriving Jews of German citizenship. Membership of the DAP grew in the 1919-23 period as people became dissatisfied with the Weimar Republic. They were also attracted by Hitler who was an energetic and passionate speaker. Membership grew to about 1100 in June 1920. On 7th August 1920, Hitler suggested the DAP change its name to the National Socialist German Workers' Party (NSDAP or Nazi Party). He adopted the swastika emblem and its members began to use the raised arm salute. Membership grew to 3000 during 1920 and the party was able to a newspaper – the Volkischer Beobachter for 180,000 marks. He also gathered around him loyal party leaders: Ernst Rohm, a scar-faced soldier; Hermann Goering, hero of the German Air Force; Rudolf Hess, wealthy academic and Hitler's deputy; Julius Streicher, founder of the Nazi paper, <i>Der Sturmer</i>. By mid-1921, Hitler pushed Drexler aside and became party Fuhrer (leader). In 1921 he also created the Sturmabteilung (SA) or storm troopers. These were the parties' private army recruited from demobilised soldiers. In 1923 he created the Stosstrupp or Shock Troop of trusted SA members as his own private bodyguard.	As the popularity of the party grew, Hitler attracted powerful friends such as General Ludendorff, leader of the German Army during the First World War. As the party grew in size and influence, they were able to take advantage of events in the 1920-23 period, especially the dissatisfaction generated by the Ruhr Crisis.



Anton Drexler 1884-1942



Adolf Hitler 1889-1945



8.) The Munich Putsch: November 1923

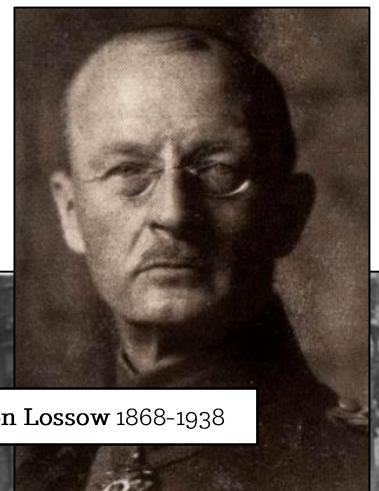
Who?	Causes	What happened?	Consequences
NSDAP led by Adolf Hitler Erich Ludendorff, ex-army general and NSDAP supporter Gustav Ritter von Kahr, leader of the Bavarian government Hans Ritter von Seisser, head of Bavarian police General Otto von Lossow, head of the army in Bavaria	Hyperinflation was serious affecting German people. The French occupation of the Ruhr was also a source of anger and shame. Hitler wanted to exploit this discontent. By Nov 1923, membership of the NSDAP had grown to 55,000. He felt strong enough to make a challenge nationally. Hitler sensed that the new government of Gustav Stresemann would soon solve the economic problems. Time was running out before the unrest died down. Stresemann's government had also started a crackdown on extremist groups. Time was running out for the NSDAP. Benito Mussolini's successful 'march on Rome' (Italy) in October 1922 had inspired Hitler to take direct action. At the height of the Ruhr Crisis, Von Kahr had banned NSDAP meetings from taking place in Sep 1923. Hitler felt he was being controlled and was under pressure to act and assert his leadership.	On the evening of 8th November 1923, there was a meeting of 3000 officials of the Bavarian government in the Burgerbrau Keller Beer Hall, Munich. The three main speakers were von Kahr, von Seisser and von Lossow. Hitler had secretly surrounded the meeting with 600 SA storm troopers and a machine gun was set-up in the hall. Hitler appeared brandishing a gun and firing it into the ceiling announcing: '<i>The national revolution has broken out! The hall is filled with 600 men. Nobody is allowed to leave.</i>' He claimed that after taking control of Munich, he would march against the government itself in Berlin. He was supported by Erich von Ludendorff, a national hero to some. Kahr, Seisser and Lossow were taken off into a side room at gunpoint where they reluctantly agree to support the uprising. However at 10.30pm, Hitler left the hall and Ludendorff allowed von Kahr and his associates to leave. This was a mistake. Von Kahr <i>et al.</i> had changed their minds and now opposed Hitler. The 2000 strong SA was suddenly outnumbered by the Bavarian police and army. Hitler sent 3000 supporters and SA to capture key buildings around the town. He then marched on the town centre (Residenzstrasse), supported by Ludendorff, the SA and his supporters. However they were met by 100 state police soldiers who opened fire on them, killing 16 Nazis with Hitler and Goering being injured. Ludendorff was arrested and the others fled. Hitler hid in the attic of a friend's house but was later arrested as well.	<u>Short-Term – Bad!</u> Hitler and three other leaders of the Putsch (Ludendorff, Rohm and Dr. Wilhelm Frick) stood trial. Hitler was found guilty of treason and sentenced to five years in Landsberg Castle prison – the minimum sentence. Ludendorff was acquitted and the others released almost immediately. Goering, Ernst Hanfstaengl and Rudolf Hess fled to Austria! Nazi party headquarter were raided and its newspaper, the <i>Volkischer Beobachter</i> (The People's Observer) and the party itself was banned until 1925. <u>Long-Term – Good!</u> Hitler used the trial to get national publicity for his views. Every word he spoke was reported in national papers the next day. The judges were impressed and he actually only served 9 months and was fined only 500 Reichmarks. As a result of the publicity, the NSDAP won its first seats in the Reichstage – 32 seats in the 1924 election. It was a propaganda victory for the NSDAP. Hitler used his time in jail to write his autobiography – <i>Mein Kampf</i> (my struggle). Hitler formed his political ideas which became a guide for the party. It focused on the need for one all-powerful leader to guide the party – <i>the Fuhrer Principle</i> Hitler also changed his approach to political change. He realised that direct action wouldn't work and decided to win power through the ballot box – <i>the Reichstag Principle</i>.



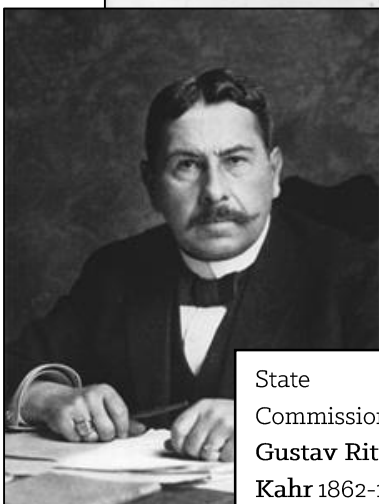
Some of the defendants at the Munich Putsch trial. From left: Heinz Pernet, Friedrich Weber, Wilhelm Frick, Hermann Kiebel, Erich Ludendorff, Adolf Hitler, Wilhelm Bruckner, Ernst Rohm and Adolf Wagner.



Head of Bavarian State Police
Hans Ritter von Seisser 1874-1973



Generalmajor Otto von Lossow 1868-1938



State
Commissioner
Gustav Ritter von
Kahr 1862-1934



The Marienplatz in Munich during the Munich Putsch.

9.) Reorganising the Nazi Party: 1924-1928

Admin and Funding	SS and SA	Propaganda	Progress by 1928
Hitler left prison in 1924 and re-launched the Nazi Party in February 1925. Hitler re-launched the Nazi Party with a focus of winning power through elections, not violence. This meant he needed better organisation and funding. Hitler appointed two efficient administrators to run Nazi HQ: Philipp Bouhler as secretary and Franz Schwarz as treasurer. He also divided the party into regions; appointing <i>gauleiters</i> who ran the party in each <i>gaue</i> or region. To fund this, Hitler befriended wealthy businessmen who shared his hatred of communism and hoped Hitler would limit the power of trade unions. By the early 1930s, the party was receiving big donations from Thyssen, Krupp and Bosch.	Extra funding was also used to strengthen the SA which expanded to 400,000 members by 1930. They were used to protect meetings and intimidate opponents like the communists. They gave the appearance of strength, order and unity to the party. Hitler also setup the SS (Schutzstaffel) protection squad in 1925 as his own private bodyguard. He was worried about SA who were difficult to control and who swore loyalty to Ernest Rohm, its commander. The SS was run at first by Julius Schreck but was replaced by Heinrich Himmler. They were known for their ruthlessness and black uniforms.	The use of propaganda became more important as the party hoped to increase its share of the vote. Dr. Joseph Goebbels was the Nazi Party <i>gauleiter</i> for Berlin and was a brilliant propagandist. He worked with Hitler to improve the party message. They created scapegoats for Germany's problems: Jews, the communists and leaders of the Weimar Republic, especially the SPD who had signed the ToV. Hitler was promoted in propaganda as the voice of the Nazi Party. By the 1930s, there were only 120 Nazi daily or weekly newspapers, reporting Hitler's speeches across the whole country. The Nazi Party also pioneered the use of radio, films and gramophone records to keep Hitler in the public eye. Hitler was famous for using aeroplanes to fly from city to city, speaking up to five times a day in some cases. Propaganda created the image of strength for the party. It focused on Hitler's passion, the spectacle of mass Nazi rallies and the impressive power of the SA and SS.	By 1928 the Nazi Party was well organised, had over 100,000 members and Hitler was a national figure. However there were problems. Since 1923, the economy had recovered, employment had increased and inflation had eased. People were better off and didn't want to vote for extremist parties. Stresemann seemed to be regaining status for Germany internationally. In 1925, Paul von Hindenburg, the 78-year-old ex-field marshal of the German Army, had become president; his reputation was a boost to the Weimar Republic and increased votes for moderate parties like the SPD, DDP, DVP and ZP. In the elections of May 1928, the Nazis won only 12 seats, were the 9th biggest party and polled only 810,000 votes (2.6%).



Joseph Goebbels 1897-1945



Heinrich Himmler 1900-1945



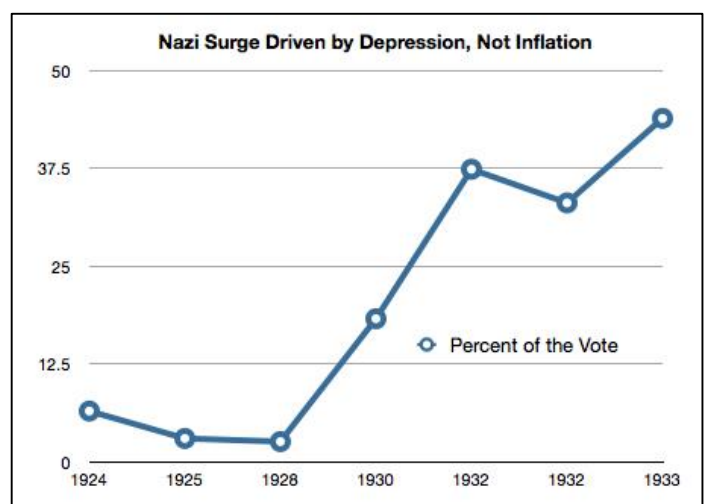
Philipp Bouhler 1899-1945



Franz Schwarz 1875-1947

10.) The Wall Street Crash: October 1929

Causes	What happened in Germany?	Consequences for Germany
In October 1929, shares prices began to fall rapidly on the Wall Street stock exchange in New York, USA. Falling shares meant people's investments fell in value. Worried about losing money, people rushed to sell shares before they fell further. On 'Black Thursday', 24th October 1929, 13 million shares were sold. Panic selling sent prices even lower. Shares worth \$20,000 in the morning were worth \$1000 by the end of the day. Within a week, investors lost \$4000 million. American banks were headed for bankruptcy so they began to <u>call in and stop their foreign loans to banks in Germany</u>.	Banks were major investors in shares and suffered huge losses. German banks lost so much money that people feared they couldn't pay out the money in bank accounts. People panicked and rushed to withdraw all their savings – causing banks to run out of cash. To make the money back, German banks recalled all their loans to German businesses. But German businesses needed the money from those loans to operate. They either had to reduce operations or close. Many businesses closed, German industrial output fell and unemployment rose. The worldwide depression meant that there was no market for German exports and high unemployment at home meant that there was no domestic demand for goods within Germany either. Therefore even more businesses closed, leading to higher unemployment and a vicious cycle emerged.	Middle classes lost savings, their businesses and their homes to the banking collapse. Workers became unemployed, further increasing the <u>welfare bill</u> for the German government. More unemployment and closing businesses and decreasing trade resulted in the government losing tax revenue at a blistering pace. This left the German government without money and struggling to afford reparations repayments. This was made worse by the fact that the government relied on American loans (Dawes Plan) that had now been recalled. From 1930-1932 the Chancellor was Heinrich Brüning who proposed to: raise taxes to pay for the cost of unemployment benefit AND reduce unemployment benefit to make payments more affordable. This pleased no one. Right-wing parties opposed higher taxes and left-wing parties opposed lower benefits. Brüning's coalition government collapsed and he had to rely on Presidential decree (Article 48) to govern. In 1930 only 5 decrees had to be used. In 1931 this rose to 44 and 66 in 1932. Decrees just undermined confidence in the Weimar Republic. Extremist parties like the Nazis and Communists benefited from public anger with the government. Many joined the private armies of political parties and violence increased across Germany.



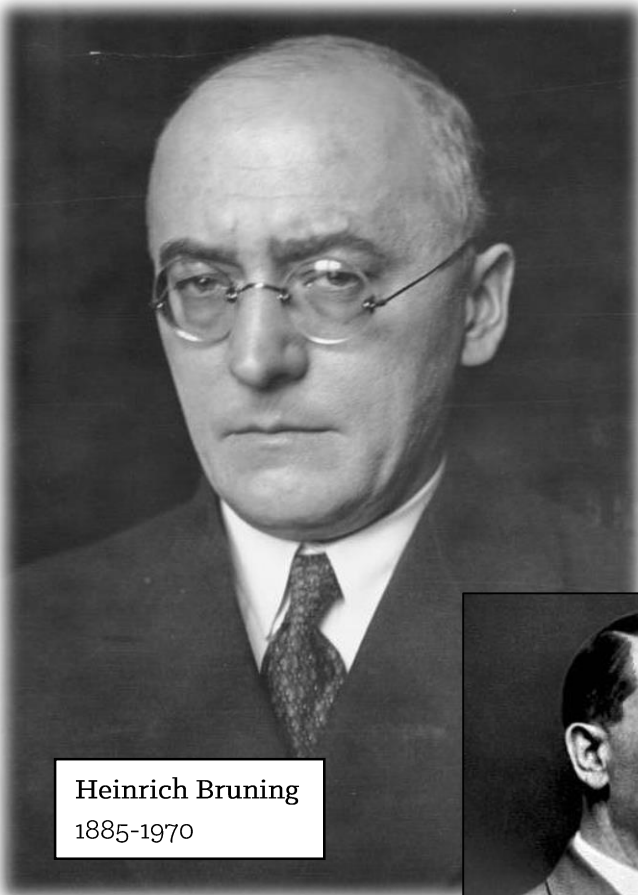
11.) Reasons for Growing Nazi Support: 1929-1932

Social Groups	Why they supported the Nazis?
Working-Class Support	Many working people were attracted by Nazi support for traditional German values and a strong Germany . There was an economic appeal too – Nazis promised 'Work and Bread' on posters. Part of the appeal was just propaganda. The Nazis used posters which gave the impression that many workers already supported them however they never really dominated the working-class vote. When times were hard, most workers supported the communists , so Nazi working-class support was important; but it wasn't enough.
Middle-Class Support	The middle class contained professional people, like teachers and lawyers, business people and small farmers. They often owned land or businesses and had savings. During the Great Depression of 1929-1932, they deserted more moderate parties, like the Social Democrats (SPD) and supported the Nazis. Why? • Many lost their companies, savings and pensions. Hitler was seen as a strong leader who could help the country recover. • The middle class were also afraid of the growing Communist Party (KPD), which wanted to abolish private ownership of land and businesses. The middle classes saw the Nazis as a strong party which could protect them from this. • There was also the view that there had been a moral decline under the Weimar Republic, including more drinking and sexual openness. The Nazis represented a return to traditional German values. This went down well with the middle classes.
Farmers	The Nazis targeted farmers' votes. The Nazi policy of confiscating all private land in the original 25-point programme was changed in 1928. The new policy said that private land would only be confiscated to protect farmers from the Communist Party , which would have confiscated their land.
Big Business	The business classes usually supported the National Party. But this party's Reichstag seats halved from 1929-32. Big Business saw Hitler as their best chance for protection from the KPD . Their support was a boost to Nazi funds and help from powerful newspaper owners like Alfred Hugenberg brought them electoral success.
Young People and Women	The young were attracted by Hitler's passionate speeches, his ambitions for the future and the atmosphere of Nazi rallies. Women did not support Hitler at first as his policies limited their role to the home. However Nazi propaganda focused on women, saying NSDAP was best for their country and best for their families.

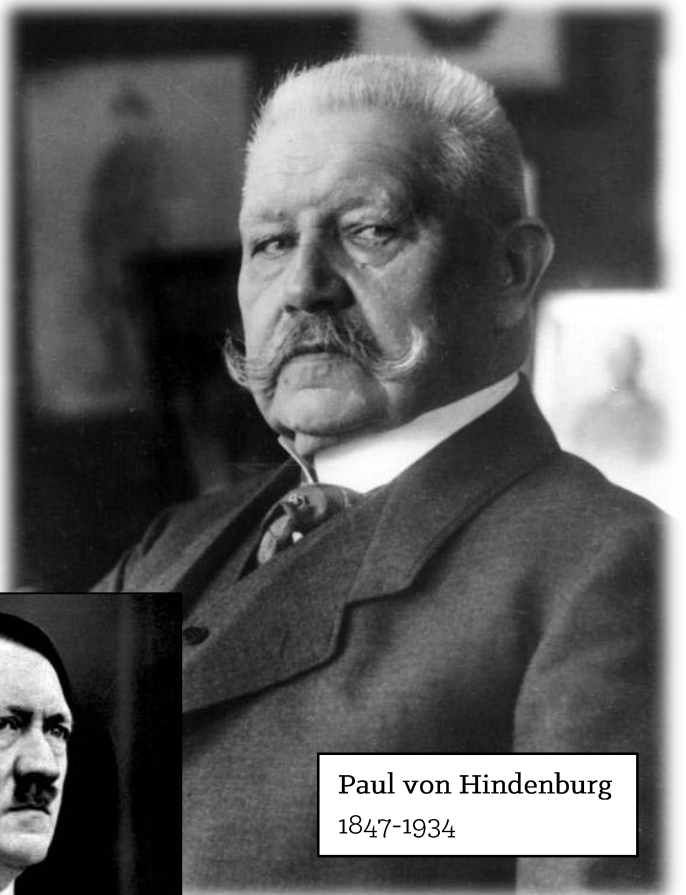


12.) How did the Nazis win power? 1932-1933

Date	Causes	Chancellor	Elections and Government	Significance
1932				
March & April	Hindenburg's seven year term as President was up. Elections took place against a backdrop of turmoil caused by the Wall Street Crash. Voters were willing to consider more extreme candidates in order to end unemployment and unrest.	Bruning	<u>Hitler stood for President and lost to Hindenburg</u> In the March elections, Hindenburg polled 18 million votes, Hitler 11 million and the Communist leader, Ernst Thälmann, 5 million. As no candidate achieved 50% of the vote, elections were held again in April. This time, whilst Hindenburg won with 19 million votes, Hitler's share increased to 13 million whilst the Communists dropped to 4 million.	Hitler became a major political figure during the elections. People were willing to consider him as President. He was second only to Hindenburg in the public eye.
May	The socialist Chancellor Brüning used a Presidential decree to ban the SA & SS in April in an attempt to calm unrest. This angered right-wing parties. Ambitious General Kurt von Schleicher decided to remove Brüning. He organised a new coalition of right-wing parties and persuaded Hindenburg that they had a majority in the Reichstag. Brüning was sacked and replaced by ex-General Franz von Papen who von Schleicher hoped to control from behind the scenes.	Von Papen	<u>Nazis asked to join government coalition</u> Von Schleicher invited the NSDAP to join the new right-wing coalition he had formed in removing Brüning. Schleicher needed NSDAP support as they were a big party. He believed that he could control the Nazis, seeing them as 'merely children who had to be led by the hand'. Hitler agreed.	For the first time, the Nazi Party was now part of the government of Germany. This led many to view the Nazis as a credible party who could govern sensibly and work with others for the good of Germany.
July	The publicity from the Presidential campaign combined with a successful election campaign to give the Nazis 230 seats in the Reichstag, up from 107 in the Sep 1930 election. Any government coalition now needed Nazi support as they were the biggest party. This made Hitler confident enough to demand the Chancellorship from Hindenburg.	Von Papen	<u>Reichstag election: Nazis now biggest party with 230 seats</u> Hitler demanded that Hindenburg sack von Papen and appoint him as Chancellor, seeing as the Nazis were now the biggest party. Hindenburg rebuffed this offer, viewing Hitler as a 'jumped up corporal'.	Becoming the largest party in the Reichstag brought tremendous power to Hitler as it meant that the Nazis could bring government to a halt by refusing to cooperate.
Nov	The Nazis responded to Hindenburg's refusal by refusing to cooperate with von Papen's government and literally walking out of Parliament at times. This left von Papen's coalition in tatters – its biggest party was refusing to cooperate so government ground to a halt.	Von Papen	<u>Reichstag election: Nazis still biggest party with 190 seats</u> Von Papen hoped that if he called fresh elections, Nazi support would decline and they would gain less seats in the Reichstag. He was wrong, whilst their seats did drop to 190, they were still the biggest party.	Von Papen had lost his last gamble – the Nazis were still the biggest party in the Reichstag and would continue with non-cooperation. Von Papen became powerless to control events and Hindenburg could not indefinitely refuse the Chancellorship to Hitler.
Dec	39 business leaders like Krupp, Siemens, Thyssen and Bosch tried to break the political deadlock by writing a letter to Hindenburg, asking him to appoint Hitler as Chancellor. They believed they could control Hitler as the Nazis relied on them for donations. Hindenburg was still opposed and appointed von Schleicher as his last remaining option.	Von Schleicher	<u>New Chancellor</u> Von Schleicher as Chancellor was confident that the Nazi vote would drop saying <i>'Herr Hitler is no longer a problem; his movement is a thing of the past'</i> . However his main problem was that he consistently failed to get a majority coalition to work in the Reichstag. In desperation, Schleicher pleaded with Hindenburg to suspend the constitution and declare him (Schleicher) as head of a military dictatorship. Hindenburg refused. News of this leaked out and Schleicher lost any remaining support in the Reichstag.	Schleicher's failure to command a majority in the Reichstag without Nazi support (190 seats!) meant that he was always doomed to be a powerless leader. With his downfall, the only remaining popular and credible right-wing leader was Hitler. Hindenburg could no longer hold out.
1933				
Jan	Von Papen had actually been plotting with Hindenburg against Schleicher for a while, and with his downfall von Papen believed his moment had returned. He persuaded Hindenburg to appoint Hitler as Chancellor with himself as vice-Chancellor, still thinking that Hitler could be controlled. Hindenburg reluctantly agreed – he had run out of options.	Hitler	<u>New Chancellor</u> On 30 th January 1933, Hitler was legally and democratically appointed Chancellor of Germany, with Hindenburg conceding, 'It is my unpleasant duty then to appoint this fellow Hitler as Chancellor'.	Appointing Hitler as Chancellor proved just how naïve the German right-wing was. They underestimated Hitler due to his ex-corporal past and lack of government experience. Hitler's power was still limited as Chancellor but he was now in a position to manipulate events to his own advantage.



Heinrich Brüning
1885-1970



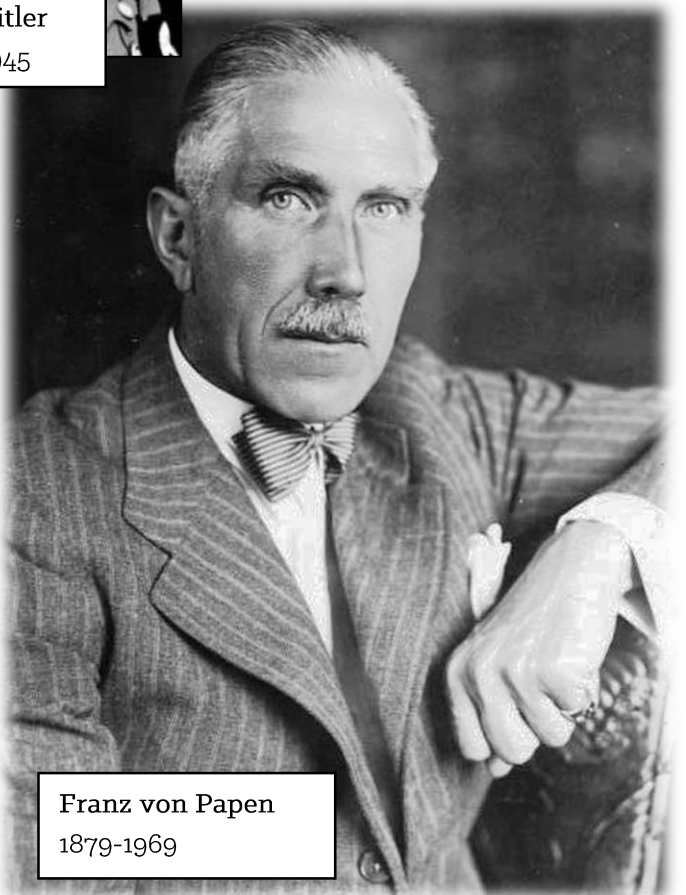
Paul von Hindenburg
1847-1934



Adolf Hitler
1889-1945



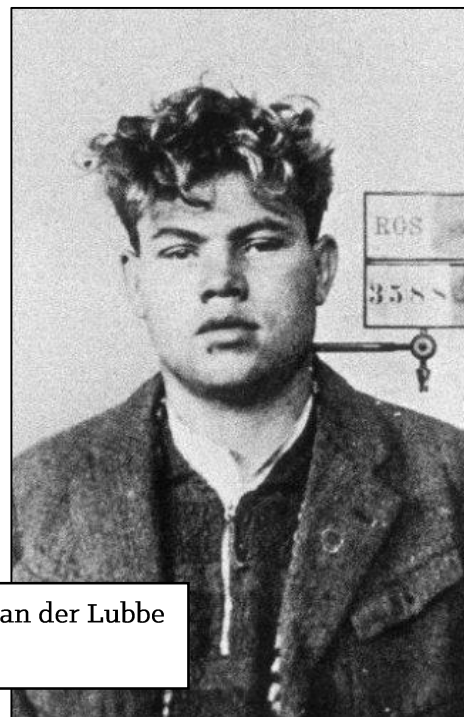
Kurt von Schleicher
1882-1934



Franz von Papen
1879-1969

13.) Removal of Opposition: 1933-1934

Event	Causes	What happened?	Consequences
Reichstag Fire Feb 1933	Whilst Hitler was Chancellor, he was still operating in a democratic system. He needed a way to persuade Hindenburg to give him more power.	On 27 th February 1933, the Reichstag building was suddenly destroyed by fire. A young Dutch communist, Marinus van der Lubbe , was caught on the site. He confessed, put on trial, found guilty and executed (beheaded!)	Hitler used the confusion and unease generated by the fire to consolidate his own power. Hitler said the fire was part of a communist conspiracy and persuaded Hindenburg to declare a state of emergency and pass the ' Law for the Protection of People and State ' on 28 th February. Hitler could now legally use decrees to govern Germany. <i>This law ended freedom of speech, freedom of association and freedom of the press.</i>
Fresh Elections 5 th March 1933	Hitler hoped to gain more seats in the Reichstag and his strong handling of the 'communist conspiracy' boosted his popularity. Now was the time to capitalise on that support.	Hitler used his new powers to make life hard on the opposition. He used the 'Law for the Protection of People and State' to imprison political opponents, prevented publication of rival newspapers, used the SA to attack rivals and called on huge funding from businessmen to promote his campaign. The election was marked by violence with over 70 deaths however the Nazis increased their seats in the Reichstag to 288, retaining their position as the biggest party.	After the election, Hitler used his emergency powers to ban the Communists from taking up the 81 seats they had won. Without the communists, and with the support of the other nationalist parties, Hitler now had a 2/3 majority in the Reichstag He now had enough votes to change the constitution of the Republic if he so wished.
The Enabling Act 23 rd Mar	Hitler had enough votes in the Reichstag to change the constitution. He just needed a 2/3 majority.	The Enabling Act was passed on 23rd March 1933 by 444 votes to 94. Communist members of the Reichstag could not attend the session, having been banned. Hitler also posted members of the SA and SS all around and inside the Kroll Opera House (temporary parliament). Members of other parties were intimidated into voting for the Act The Act changed the constitution of the Weimar Republic and gave Hitler the right to make laws for four years without the consent of the Reichstag. It marked the end of Democracy and the end of the Weimar Republic as Hitler, not the elected Reichstag, made the law.	He immediately used his new powers to pass laws which turned Germany into a totalitarian state: - To stop the threat of a nationwide strike, in May 1933 Hitler used his new powers to ban trade unions and make strikes illegal. - In July 1933 he issued the 'Law against the Establishment of Parties'. Article 1 removed all opposition and declared the NSDAP as the only legal Party. - Local government was also brought under tighter central control. In January 1934, Hitler banned all regional parliaments and declared that governors, appointed by him, would run every region.
The Night of the Long Knives 30 th June	Hitler feared Ernst Rohm, leader of the SA. 3 million SA were loyal to Rohm and he opposed Hitler's policies, particularly his links to big business.	On 30th June 1934, Hitler arranged for Rohm and other senior officers of the SA, to be arrested, imprisoned and shot. Rohm was taken to Stadelheim jail and on 1st July an SS brigade leader arrived and left a loaded pistol in his cell. After 15 minutes Rohm was still alive so he was shot along with 6 other SA leaders. Over 4 days about 400 people including 150 senior members of the SA were shot. This included General von Schleicher, his wife and Gregor Strasser. Von Papen escaped.	The Night of the Long Knives proved that Hitler was now acting illegally by murdering his rivals for power. He claimed to be doing this in the interests of Germany. Some Germans objected to the violence but most were grateful that the SA, hated for their brutality, had been restrained. SA continued after 1934 but was limited to giving muscle to the Nazi party and was now firmly under Hitler's control.
Death of Hindenburg 2 nd August	The only opposition left to Hitler lied in the President, Hindenburg.	On 2 nd August 1934, President Hindenburg died, aged 87, and Hitler moved in to take over supreme power. He declared himself Germany's Fuhrer, took all of the president's power and forced an oath of loyalty to him from every soldiers in the Army.	A plebiscite was organised to confirm and add legitimacy to his role of Fuhrer. Bombarded by pro-Nazi propaganda, 90% of votes decided in his favour. Hitler now had supreme power. The Third Reich had begun.



Marinus van der Lubbe
1909-1934



Ernst Rohm
1887-1934



Gregor Strasser
1892-1934



14.) Growth of the Nazi Police State: 1933-45

Element	How were they used?	Significance
The SS	SS was a military group set up in 1925 as a personal bodyguard for Hitler. From 1929 it was run by Heinrich Himmler . Main role was as the Nazi Party's own private police force. They were totally loyal to Hitler and Hitler used SS officers to murder SA officers in the Night of the Long Knives . During the 1930s, the SS expanded to over 50,000 men and were in charge of all the other state security services. Another role of the SS was to carry out the Nazi policy of racial purification. The SS Totenkopf (Death's Head Units) ran concentration camps. SS members had to be 'racially pure' and could only marry 'racially pure' wives.	The SS was a significant organisation as it helped the Nazi Party to control the SA and regular army . SS officers were often the most ideologically fanatical Nazi's and would carry out Hitler's orders without hesitation. It was the loyalty of the SS that enabled Hitler to efficiently carry out the 'final solution'.
The Gestapo	The <i>Geheime Staatspolizei</i> was Hitler's non-uniformed secret police force. Set up in 1933 by Hermann Goering and placed under the control of the SS in 1936. Gestapo was led by Reinhard Heydrich . They arrested people who acted against or spoke out in any way against Nazi ideas. Offenders were imprisoned without trial. By 1939, 150,000 people were 'under protective arrest' in prison and few would ever see release. The Gestapo used various methods to monitor the population such as phone tapping, spying and the use of informers.	The Gestapo was a significant element of the Nazi Police State as the Gestapo could act outside the law and was only responsible to its commanders and Hitler . The Gestapo consolidated control of German society through fear and worked to eliminate any opposition to Hitler.
Prison Camps	The first concentration camp was opened in Dachau in 1933. Another for women was opened later that year at Moringen . Camps were located in isolated areas outside cities away from the public. They were controlled by the SS. At first, most inmates were political prisoners and 'undesirables' like prostitutes and minority groups, such as Jews or Gypsies. From 1938, the SS used camp inmates as slave labour for business enterprises. By 1939 there were 6 camps holding about 20,000 people. After 1939, their size grew in numbers and were used for the mass murder of minority groups.	The use of concentration camps was significant as it boosted the German economy during the war . It was also an efficient, if morally reprehensible, way for Hitler to deal with the opposition and his control on society – undesirables were simply sent to camps and never seen again, often murdered or worked to death.
The Law Courts	Hitler took control of the judiciary firstly by setting up 'the National Socialist League for the Maintenance of the Law' . All judges had to be members. It enabled the Nazi's to monitor the decisions of judges, to ensure they followed Nazi Party priorities. Hitler also gave judges the freedom to punish people even if they had not broken the law. Secondly, Hitler set up a new 'People's Court' , to hear all treason cases – offenses against the state. Judges were hand-picked for loyalty and Hitler would often intervene in cases.	Hitler's control of the Law Courts ensured that all elements of the judiciary would follow Nazi Party priorities and judgements . It also strengthened their control of society by punishing people for their political views.



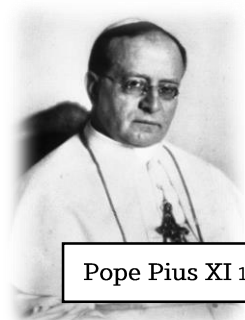
Heinrich Himmler 1900-1945



Reinhard Heydrich 1904-1942

15.) The Nazis and Christianity: 1933-45

Church	Causes	How did Hitler control this Church?	Consequences
The Catholic Church	Catholic Christians swear loyalty to God and follow the instructions of the Pope in Rome. Hitler disliked this as in his totalitarian state, he believed all German's should look to him as their Fuhrer for instruction and devotion. Christianity was also treated with suspicion as it preached forgiveness, tolerance and peace – completely different to the Nazi message of strength, violence and survival of the fittest. 1/3 of all German Christians were Catholic and they also had their own schools which would teach children Christian, not Nazi ethics. Clearly something had to be done to monitor and control this Church.	At first, Hitler tried to reach an agreement with the Catholic Church and in July 1933, signed the 'Concordat' (agreement) with the Pope. Hitler agreed: - To respect freedom of worship for Catholics - To not interfere with Catholic schools in Germany The Roman Catholic Church agreed to: - Instruct its priests not to interfere in Politics - Ordered German bishops to swear loyalty to the National Socialist regime. By the end of the 1930s, Hitler changed his mind and began to persecute the Catholic Church: - Catholic priests were harassed and arrested with many ending up in concentration camps. - Catholic schools were closed or brought in to line with state schools and curriculums. - Catholic youth groups like the Catholic Youth League, were banned. By 1937, Pope Pius XI realised that the Concordat was worthless and he issued a criticism of the Nazi Regime known as 'Mit Brennender Sorge' (<i>With Burning Anxiety</i>)	The signing of the Concordat actually worked to reduce opposition to Hitler's policies from Catholic Christians. It seemed as if the Nazi Regime was one that respected Christian traditions and ethics. It explains why there was little opposition to Hitler's policies at first. The breaking of the Concordat in 1937 did encourage Catholics to oppose Nazi policies however State control of society was too strong by this point. The repression of the Catholic Church by Hitler weakened opposition and served to strengthen his control of society.
The Protestant Church	The relationship between the Nazis and the Protestant Churches was actually better at first. Many protestant churches supported the Nazis as they feared the anti-Christian Communists. Hitler was seen as the protector of German social and religious traditions. This respect broke down over time as Nazi social policies and control of society increased.	Some Protestants formed the German Christian Movement led by Ludwig Muller. Hitler made Muller the Reich bishop of Germany in September 1933. This movement tried to fuse Nazi ethics and ideas into traditional Christianity. For instance, Nazi flags were displayed inside Churches and Hitler was portrayed as the protector of the Church from Judaism and Atheistic-Communism. Other Protestant Christians did oppose Hitler's policies and spoke out against him. Pastor Martin Niemoller set up the Pastors' Emergency League (PEL) in 1933 to campaign against Nazi actions. In 1937, Niemoller was sent to a concentration camp and the PEL was banned.	Although the Nazi Party couldn't completely control German Christians, Hitler did successfully manage to weaken their potential opposition to his policies. The concordat with the Catholic Church and German Christian Movement in 1933 actually give legitimacy to Hitler's regime. By the late 1930s it was too late for any sizable Christian opposition to form – Hitler had complete control of the judiciary, legislature and executive.



Pope Pius XI 1857-1939

Ludwig Muller 1883-1945



Martin Niemoller 1892-1984



16.) Censorship and Propaganda: 1933-45

Element	Censorship	Propaganda
Campaigning	Before 1933, the Nazi Party used the SA to disrupt opposition meetings, tear down their propaganda posters and violently intimidate their speakers. This attempt at censoring their message was never 100% successful. The July 1933 ' Law Against the Establishment of Parties ' enabled Hitler to ban all other political parties – in effect this made campaigning by other political parties illegal.	After 1933, Joseph Goebbels was in charge of government propaganda. He could use government resources to publicise Hitler and his views. Propaganda methods included: - Government posters advertising Nazi views and policies - Expanding the use of rallies and parades to intimidate the public. Torchlight parades, brass bands and massed choirs were all used to great effect. The Nuremberg Rally which was held each year to create a sense of spectacle, Nazi strength and German unity.
Radio	Goebbels placed all radio stations under Nazi control . He also made it a treasonable offense to listen to foreign radio broadcasts like the BBC. In 1939, over 1500 Germans were arrested for listening to London-based broadcasts.	Hitler made frequent broadcasts on radio. Cheap mass-produced radios were sold or placed in cafes, factories and schools; some speakers were even placed in streets to spread the Nazi message. The Nazis introduced two cheap radios called 'people's receivers' costing 35 and 72 marks. By the 1930s there were more radios per person in Germany than anywhere else in Europe.
Cinema	From 1934, film-makers had to send the plot of every new film to Goebbels for approval.	In 1933, German cinema had audiences of over 250 million a year. Films were shown alongside a 45-minute official government newsreel, publishing Nazi achievements. Propaganda feature films were made like <i>The Eternal Jew</i> by Fritz Hippler, <i>Hitlerjunge Quex</i> by Hans Steinhoff and <i>Triumph of the Will</i> by Leni Riefenstahl that tried to spread the message of the Nazi Party through mass entertainment.
The Press	Newspapers had to print views which the Ministry agreed with or face the consequences. If they didn't, newspapers could be banned, forcing owners into bankruptcy. Reich Press Law of 4 th Oct 1933 banned all Jewish or liberal editors and journalists from working.	Journalists were given briefings with information the government wanted to publicise. Völkischer Beobachter (Racial Observer) was the primary newspaper of the Nazi Party, printed in Munich. Der Angriff (The Assault) was founded by Goebbels in 1927, printed in Berlin. Der Stürmer (The Attacker) was owned by anti-Semite Julius Streicher. Hitler claimed it was his favourite.
Universities	University academics had to support Nazi views or face dismissal. Between 1933-1938 3000 academics were dismissed . Anyone appointed to a university had to be approved by government and had to complete a 6-week training course at a National Socialist Lecturers Alliance Camp .	The Nazis realised the powerful role university staff have in shaping young minds. They were also fearful of allowing too much independence for academics . Senior professors and rectors were therefore handpicked by Nazis to ensure loyalty.
The Arts	Goebbels controlled the arts through the Reich Chamber of Culture . All writers, musicians, artists and actors had to be members or could be barred from working, however most artists practiced ' self-censorship '. Nazis decided what books would be available. Millions of books were banned and burnt on huge public bonfires like in Berlin on 10th May 1933. Authors could only write about 4 topics: front experience, world view, regional novels and racial doctrine. By 1939, 2500 authors had left Germany including Bertolt Brecht and Thomas Mann. Music was censored. Jazz music was banned as it was seen as black music and inferior. Composers like Mendelssohn was banned because he was part Jewish. 'Degenerate Art' (Entartet) was banned. Modern art was almost entirely banned. Expressionism, Cubism and Impressionism was all banned. All artists had to join the Reich Chamber of Visual Arts. 42,000 artists were given approval.	- Art was used as a form of propaganda by the Nazis. Nazi art was based on 'Classical Realism'. It emphasised strength, unity and German folk tales. Hitler wanted art to display the 'true German spirit'. - The Nazis put on 'degenerate art' displays like in Munich on 31st March 1936. People were encouraged to criticise it and appreciate its 'foreignness'. - Hitler's favourite music was by Robert Wagner who he thought 'personified' Nazism.
Sport	Minority groups were not allowed to compete for the German national teams during the Olympics. All athletes had to be 'Aryans'. However during the Berlin Olympics, the Black American athlete Jessie Owens won four gold medals.	Hitler and Goebbels used the 1936 Berlin Olympics to show Nazi Germany in a good light. The film maker Leni Riefenstahl was employed to produce a feature film of the event. The Nazis built an Olympic stadium seating 110,000 people to reflect the power of Germany. All events were organised faultlessly, showing German efficiency and Germany won the most medals, 33 golds.
Hitler as Fuhrer		A key feature of Nazi Propaganda was Hitler himself. His image was used to personify the Nazi Party and unify the nation. He was shown as a strong and decisive figure . He was also pictured with children and families as a caring father-figure for the nation.

17.) Youth and Education: 1933-45

Education	Nazi Control
Schools	- All children attended school until they were 14. Boys and girls went to separate schools and the Nazis controlled all elements of the school curriculum. - New subjects like Race Studies taught children that Aryans were superior and they should not marry Jews. Mein Kampf became a compulsory school text. - History lessons criticised communism and the Treaty of Versailles. - Girls had different lessons from boys. Domestic science, including cookery and needle work, was compulsory for girls. - PE took up about one-sixth of school time, to emphasise good health for girls and boys. - Teachers had to swear an oath of loyalty to Hitler and join the Nazi Teachers' League where they were indoctrinated with Nazi political views. - Teachers taught children the Nazi salute and started each lesson with the children saying 'Heil Hitler'.
Youth Movements	- The Nazi government closed down youth clubs and activities run by other groups like the Catholic Church. - The Nazis setup their own youth clubs to reflect Nazi ideas. - Boys joined: Pimpf (Little Fellows) from the age of 6. Jungvolk (Young Germans) from the age of 10. Hitler Jugend (Hitler Youth) from the age of 14. - Girls joined: Young Madel (Young Maidens) from age of 10-14. Bund Deutscher Madel (League of German Maidens) from 14-18. - All groups had uniforms and had to swear loyalty to the Nazi Party. - Activities encourages good health, good citizenship and support for the Nazis. Sports, Camping and Hiking were popular activities. Group activities encouraged co-operation and comradeship. - Boys mainly did marching drills, map-reading, signalling and rifle shooting. - Girls mainly did cooking, setting up camps and motherhood activities. - After 1939, the Hitler Youth was used to help the war effort on the home front, helping air raid wardens and fire brigades during bombing.



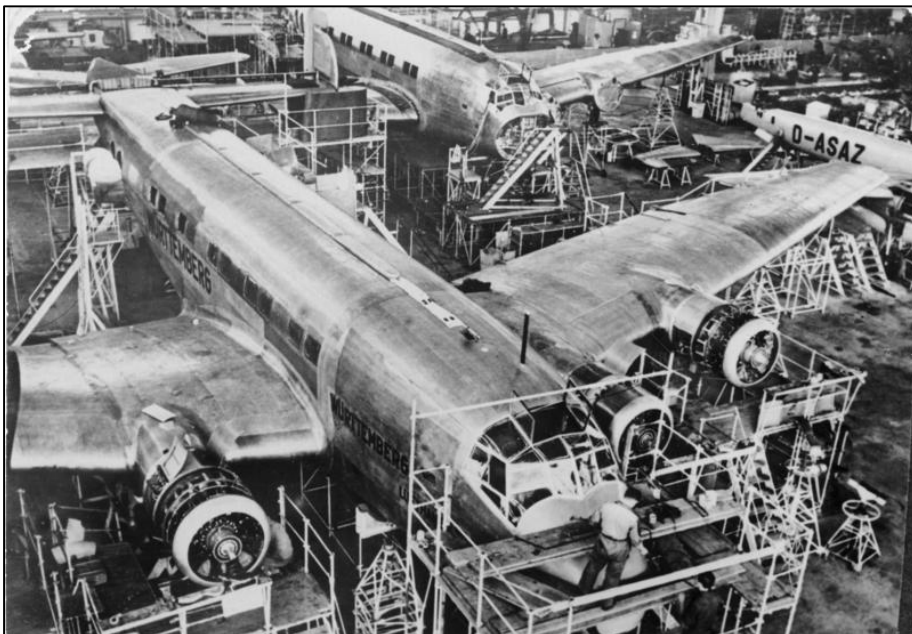
18.) Women in Nazi Germany: 1933-45

Attitudes to Women	
Women in the 1920s	- In Weimar Germany, women over 20 years were given the vote and there were about 20 female members of the Reichstag. - Women became more likely to go out to work and more likely to work in the professions, often being paid equal to men. Over 100,000 female teachers in Germany by 1933. - Women also started to enjoy more freedom in social activities outside the family, such as drinking and going to nightclubs. - Women also dressed differently, being influenced by the American 'flapper' style popular in the 1920s.
Nazi views on Women	- The Nazi party believed that women should fit into society in a traditional way and the best way women could do this was to be mothers. - To be good mothers, German women should: - Stay healthy - Learn housecraft like cookery and needlework - Marry and make their husbands happy so they become good workers - Bear children and bring them up to be good Germans - Stay at home and concentrate on domestic matters, not work or politics. - Not wear make-up or trousers, or to dye or perm their hair.
Nazi Policies towards Women	- German Women's Enterprise was formed, to arrange classes and radio broadcasts, teaching good motherhood - Women were encouraged to leave work and concentrate on the 3Ks – <i>kinder, kuche, kirche</i> (children, kitchen and church) - Some professional women were forced to leave their jobs as doctors, lawyers or teachers in order to free up jobs for men and reduce unemployment. Law for the Encouragement of Marriage in 1933 was introduced to increase the birth rate. It provided loans of 1000 marks (9 months wages) to young couples to marry, as long as the wife left work. For each of their first four children, the couple could keep a quarter of the loan. The Mother's Cross was awarded to women based on the number of children they had to encourage them to have more. Bronze for four or five, silver for six or seven and gold for eight or more. Each year on Hitler's mother's birthday (12th April) medals were distributed. The Lebensborn programme (fountain of life) was another policy to encourage childbirth. Started in 1935 by SS leader Heinrich Himmler, it attempted to encourage the creation of 'ideologically pure' children for adoption. It made single women available for fertilisation by SS men. In one home alone, 540 mothers gave birth from 1938-41.
Women during WW2	By the end of the 1930s, German industry was expanding so quickly that women were needed to work so some of the early policies were scaled back or reversed.



19.) The Nazi Economy: 1933-39

Nazi Economic Policies	
Nazi Policy towards workers	- Trade Unions were banned in 1933 by Hitler as he believed that unions could seriously disrupt the economy. The German Labour Front (DAF) was set-up in 1933 to replace all other unions. Its role was to ensure that workers served the best interests of the Nazi regime. - The DAF also controlled the power of the employers to ensure the economy worked smoothly. - The DAF set employment rights for all workers in factories, mines, munitions plants and shipyards. It regulated working hours and rates of pay.
Nazi Policy towards the unemployed	- Hitler believed that unemployment sapped the strength of a nation and unemployed workers were more likely to support the communists. The National Labour Service (RAD) was set-up in 1933 which forced unemployed workers to work for the government. It was voluntary at first but from 1935 it was made compulsory for all young men to serve six months. - The RAD organised men to live like an army, providing them with uniforms. They lived in camps and did military drill and parades as well as work. Rates of pay were very low as was food. - The RAD used men to build public buildings, motorways (autobahns) and to work in fields. By 1939, Germany had over 7000 miles of autobahns.
Rearmament	- Nazi economic policy was designed to make Germany strong and it needed a strong military to achieve this. - In 1936, Hitler issued a secret memo, declaring that the economy must be reorganised to make Germany able to wage war within four years. Hitler's <u>four year plan</u> had several effects on Germany: - Government spending on rearmament increased. - In 1933, spending on arms was 3.5 billion marks - By 1939, it was 26 billion marks. - Army's need for iron and steel increased. - German production trebled from 1933-39. - Germany wanted self-sufficiency in products like plastic, oil and rubber. - Production of plastic increased by 460% in the 1930s. - The German Army grew in size: - About 100,000 in 1933 - About 500,000 in 1936 - About 900,000 in 1939, - As the army grew in size, so did the demand for uniforms and equipment. Rearmament was thus a huge boost for the German economy. Unemployment went down and production and profits went up.
Effects of Nazi Industrial Policy	- Banning trade unions and reducing unemployment reduced political opposition to the Nazis from the right. - Protecting workers' rights and reducing unemployment also helped ordinary Germans. - Unemployment fell from 4.8 million in 1933 to 1.6 million in 1936 and 0.5 million in 1938. - By 1939, Germany was ready for war. - Public works and rearmament was expensive. <u>Was unemployment really down?</u> Most jobs had been created by forcing women and Jews out of jobs and by expanding the army, SS and Gestapo.



Bundesarchiv, Bild 146-1980-003-31
Foto: o. Ang. | 1938

20.) Persecution of the Jews: 1933-39

Stages	How persecuted?
Anti-Semitism in Germany before Hitler	Anti-Jewish views (anti-Semitism) had been common in Europe for hundreds of years. This was because: their religion, customs and looks made them stand out as 'different' in European society; some Christians hated Jews, blaming them for the execution of Christ (blood libel). People often looked for scapegoats when times were hard and Jews were often singled-out: - Some Germans wrongly blamed defeat in WW1 on the Jews. - Jews were criticised for being communist rebels. Kurt Eisner, the leader of the communist rising in Munich in 1918 was Jewish. - Many Jews were wealthy business people and criticised for being selfish capitalists.
Hitler's Views and <i>Mein Kampf</i> 1925	In 1925, Hitler published his auto-biography, <i>Mein Kampf</i>, which contained his racial and political views. He claimed there was a hierarchy of races among other things: - The Aryan (German) race was the superior race – the <i>Herrenvolk</i> or master race. They were seen as tall, blond, blue-eyed and athletic. - Other races, such as the <i>Slavs</i> of Eastern Europe were inferior, lesser races. <i>Untermenschen</i> or sub-humans included Africans. The worst were gypsies and Jews. Hitler later called them <i>Lebensunwertes</i> – unworthy of life.
First Nazi Persecutions 1933+	When the Nazis came to power in 1933, Hitler started to pass laws against the Jews: - The Nazis boycotted Jewish businesses - Jews were banned from government jobs - Jews were banned from inheriting land. - In 1935, Jews were banned from the army and restaurants.
The Nuremberg Laws 1935	On 15th September 1935, the Nuremberg Laws were passed which said Jews: - Not be German citizens - Lost the right to vote, hold government office or have passports - Could not marry German citizens. - From 1938, Jewish doctors, lawyers and dentists could not work for white Aryan Germans. - Jewish identity cards had to carry a large letter 'J' for 'Jew'. - Jews had to register all possessions.
Kristallnacht	On 7th November 1938, a young Polish Jew, Hershel Grynszpan, went into the German embassy in Paris and shot Ernst von Rath, a German. He hated the Germans for their persecution of the Jews. A wave of anger swept Germany and von Rath died on the 9th November. Goebbels announced in the Nazi paper, <i>Der Strumer</i>, that the Fuhrer said that the government would not prevent Germans from taking revenge on the Jews. On 9th and 10th of November, a storm of attacks on Jews and their property took place across Germany. The SA and SS took part. Some Germans were horrified but many took part as well. 814 shops, 171 homes and 191 synagogues were destroyed. At least 100 Jews were killed. These events became known as <i>Kristallnacht</i> (Crystal Night) or the Night of Broken Glass.
After Kristallnacht	Goebbels announced that Jews would be fined 1 billion marks to pay for the damage, banned from running shops or businesses and banned from school or universities. The SA and SS all started to round up Jews. By 12th November 1938, 20,000 Jews had been sent to concentration camps. In 1939, persecution increased: - In January, the <u>Reich Office for Jewish Emigration</u> was set up to remove Jews from Germany by enforced emigration. - In April, orders were sent that all Jews were to be evicted from their homes and forced into areas in cities called <u>ghettos</u>. Here they had to wait to be deported.

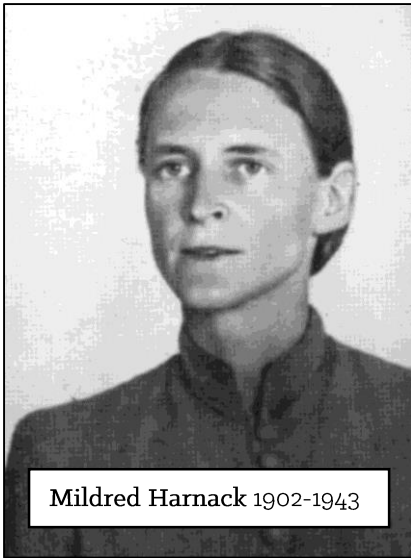
21.) War and the Final Solution: 1939-45

Method	Treatment of Jews	How different?	Reasons for Change
Ghettos	When the Nazis invaded Poland in 1939, they built ghettos in all major cities. Ghettos were walled-off, guarded parts of cities where Jews were forced to live. Jews from Germany and occupied countries were sent there. In Warsaw, the Nazis crushed 380,000 Jews, 30% of the population, into a ghetto 3% of the size of the city . By 1942, 50,000 Jews had died from hunger, cold and disease.	Forcing Jews into ghettos marked a change in Nazi policy. The Nazis were now using force to remove Jews . The Ghettos reinforced Nazi propaganda about Jews being dirty and forced many people outside ghettos to view Jews as 'sub-human'.	Nazis wanted to isolate Jews from the rest of society, free valuable Jewish property for Nazi use and control the movements of Jews.
Concentration Camps	The Nazis built camps as early as 1933 but at first they were camps for all political prisoners. After 1939 the size and number of the camps grew. In 1937, the Buchenwald camp in Germany was set-up for 1,000 prisoners. By 1939 it held 10,000 and by the end of war, over 80,000. 56,000 Jews died at Buchenwald between 1937 to 1945 .	In the ghettos, Jews faced tough living conditions but were often left alone. In camps, they were used as slave labour and many died from overwork, starvation and mistreatment . During the war, a deliberate policy to exterminate workers through overwork was introduced.	The war economy needed extra workers so concentration camps provided an endless supply of slave labour . They also allowed the Nazis to control the Jews more closely, away from the general public.
Einsatzgruppen	The Einsatzgruppen were SS death squads. Between 1939 and 1941, they followed the German army into Poland and the USSR, systematically murdering any civilians regarded as undesirable.	The Einsatzgruppen were created to deliberately murder undesirables . This was new. There was no cover story for this group. In the village of Ponary in Lithuania, over 50,000 Jews were shot . By 1945, they had killed 1.5 million Jews, gypsies and communist leaders .	By invading Poland and the USSR, the Nazis came into contact with many people they considered 'undesirable'. The Einsatzgruppen was a way to rid themselves of these people .
Final Solution	In January 1942, leading Nazis met at Wannsee House , in Berlin, to work out how to deal with the Jewish people. It was agreed that all Jews under German control would be exterminated. Reinhard Heydrich , head of the Gestapo, was in charge of the plans. All Jews were to be transported to areas of Eastern Europe under Nazi control. Fit people would be housed in labour camps and worked to death. Others would be sent to death camps and gassed to death.	This decision called ' the final solution ' marked the final step in the Holocaust. Before, the extermination of the Jewish people was uncoordinated and haphazard. Now the entirely apparatus of Nazi government would be used to organise the extermination of an entire people .	After the invasion of the USSR in June 1941, 4 million Jews came under Nazi control. The Nazi leadership argued over what to do with them. Goering argued they could be used for slave labour, Himmler argued they were too expensive to keep and should be all exterminated.
Death Camps	The first death camp was built in March 1942 at Belzec in Poland. Others included Auschwitz, Chelmo, Majdanek, Sobibor and Treblinka . Camps were run by SS officers. Prisoners arrived by train. Their belongings taken, then herded into gas chambers. By 1944, about 90% of all Jews in Germany, Austria and Poland had been killed .	Death camps were designed purely for the extermination of undesirables, mainly Jews. By 1945, over 6 million Jews had been exterminated by the Nazis. This mass slaughter became known as the Holocaust.	Some existing labour camps were converted, but many death camps had to be built from scratch. They were a way for the Nazis to implement the final solution.



22.) Opposition to Hitler & the Home Front: 1939-45

Opposition Groups	What did they do?
<u>Political Opposition</u> <i>In 1933 Hitler banned all political parties except for the NSDAP. Normal political opposition was impossible so people had to find other ways to undermine the regime. Passing on information to foreign governments was one way to undermine the Nazi government.</i>	Liselotte Herrmann was a student member of the KDP in 1933. She got information from sympathetic government official about secret weapons projects, illegal under the Treaty of Versailles. She sent information to the KDP offices abroad. She was discovered in December 1935, tried, found guilty of treason and in June 1938, beheaded. Mildrid Harnack was a university teacher who formed a resistance group among her students, gathering information on Nazi activities, sending it to the US and USSR. Her husband, Arvid Harnack, was a civil servant. In 1938, Arvid began regular secret meetings with an American diplomat in Berlin, passing on valuable information about Nazi war preparations. In 1940 they began to work with Harro Schulze-Boysen and the three became the centre of a network of spies. In 1942 all three were arrested and executed. The Nazis nicknamed their organisation 'Red Orchestra'.
<u>White Rose Group</u> <i>Formed due to their opposition to the war, especially after the attack on the USSR stalled in 1942. Many students served in the German army and hated the atrocities they saw.</i>	Started at University of Munich in 1941 by students Hans and Sophie Scholl, and their philosophy teacher Kurt Huber. Their group was politicised by the atrocities they saw carried out by the German army whilst serving. They believed in opposing the Nazi regime by peaceful means. They began by mailing leaflets, anonymously, to people all over Germany, concentrating on lecturers and owners of bars and restaurants. Their leaflets called for democracy and social justice. By 1943, they became confident and left leaflets in public places. On 18th February, Hans and Sophie were seen and reported to the Gestapo. Within two days they were tried and executed. 80 others were soon arrested.
<u>The Edelweiss Pirates</u> <i>Formed at first by rebellious youths who resented being forced to join the Nazi youth groups. As the war went on, conditions worsened due to Allied bombing. Morale fell and many more youths joined groups like the Pirates.</i>	The Edelweiss Pirates was a youth group formed by rebellious youths. They found simple ways to rebel like girls mixing with boys, listening to modern 'swing' music and growing their hair long. They often daubed anti-Nazi slogans on walls; beat up members of the Hitler Youth. They were over 2,000 members of the Pirates by 1939. After war broke out, groups like the Pirates became more political. Some supported the Allies; helping army deserters or distributing Allied propaganda leaflets dropped by aeroplane. After 1942, conditions worsened. Youngsters became more daring and smashed factories involved in war production and stealing guns. In 1944, Himmler ordered a crackdown and hundreds were arrested. In Cologne, 13 young activists were arrested and publically hanged.
<u>Religious Opposition</u> <i>In the 1930s some members of the Protestant and Roman Catholic churches criticised the Nazi regime and individual clergy tried to do more.</i>	Dietrich Bonhoeffer was a Protestant pastor who joined the German military intelligence and tried to use his position there to undermine the Nazis. He passed messages to the Allied and helped Jews escape into Switzerland. He was caught in 1943 and hanged in 1945.
<u>Military Opposition</u> <i>The officer class in German society had never been natural supporters of the Nazis and disliked the paramilitary SA and SS. While the war was successful, opposition was subdued but as the war went badly, opposition increased.</i>	July Bomb Plot of 1944 – Colonel Claus von Stauffenberg was one of many senior officers at the War Office in Berlin who, by 1944, believed that Hitler was leading Germany to inevitable defeat. On 20th July, he took a bomb inside a briefcase into a meeting with Hitler and placed it under the map-table Hitler was using. The bomb blew up 12 minutes later but had been moved. Over 5,000 were arrested for their suspected part in the plot; 19 generals and 27 colonels, including Stauffenberg, were executed.



Mildred Harnack 1902-1943



Arvid Harnack 1901-1942



Harro Schulze-Boysen 1909-1942



Dietrich Bonhoeffer 1906-1945



Henning von Tresckow 1901-1944



Colonel Claus von Stauffenberg 1907-1944

23.) The Defeat and Death of Hitler: 1939-1945

Why was the Nazi regime defeated?

- Between 1939 and 1941, the **Second World War went well for Hitler**. In 1939 he invaded Western Poland. In 1940 he defeated Denmark, Norway, Holland, Belgium and France. In June 1941, Yugoslavia, Greece and the USSR were invaded.
- 1941-42 was a **turning point**. The USA joined the Allies in December 1941, and during 1942, the attack on the USSR stalled, whilst the Allies won victories in North Africa.
- 1943-44 saw the **tide turn**. Germany lost the **Battle of Stalingrad** in February 1943. In September, Allies invaded Italy from North Africa and in June 1944, they invaded France. The Germans were on the retreat everywhere. By April 1945, the Soviet Army had reached Berlin. On 30th April 1945, Hitler killed himself in his underground bunker in Berlin.

Germany failed to defeat Britain in an air and sea war	The failure to defeat Britain early in the war meant that Hitler was forced to fight a two-front war . The Battle of Britain in July-September 1940 was Hitler's attempt to invade Britain. Goering's Luftwaffe targeted British cities and airfields in an attempt to force Britain into surrender. He failed which meant that Britain could be used as a launch pad for the Allies to build up their military strength against Hitler.
Hitler decided to invade the Soviet Union	The decision to invade the Soviet Union was a massive mistake which drew German forces into a long, drawn-out struggle. From June 1941, Hitler invaded the Soviet Union with a force of 3 million and by winter, had reached Moscow. However the war turned against Hitler after the Battle of Stalingrad ended in February 1943. Over 90,000 German soldiers surrendered. From this point on, there was never less than 65% of the German Army fighting the Russians . By April 1945, the Russian had pushed the Germans all the way back to Berlin.
Decision to declare war on the USA	The decision to declare war on the USA after Pearl Harbour in December 1941 was clearly disastrous. Once the United States joined the Allies, the men, machines and munitions available to the Allies far outweighed Germany's. It became a war of attrition ; Germany was worn down by a stronger enemy. By 1944, Germany was losing this war of production . The Allies were producing: twice as much steel; x4 as many planes and tanks; x7 as many rifles and machine guns. When the Allies invaded France on D-Day (6 th June 1944), they had an air superiority of 70:1 .
Hitler made poor decisions	It was Hitler's decision to invade the USSR . Its economy was weak but Russia was a huge country, with a population of over 200 million and a harsh fighting climate. To make matters worse, Hitler interfered in military decisions , refusing to allow the army to withdraw from Stalingrad and not seeing the importance of North Africa. He also backed the wrong scientific projects . Whilst the Allies invested in radar, cipher machines and the atomic bomb, Hitler invested in V1 and V2 rockets which did nothing to change the war.
Nazi philosophy	Nazi philosophies also slowed down the war effort . Hitler allowed the SS and the German Army too much control of the economy. He was also slow to use women in the labour force, slowing the economy.



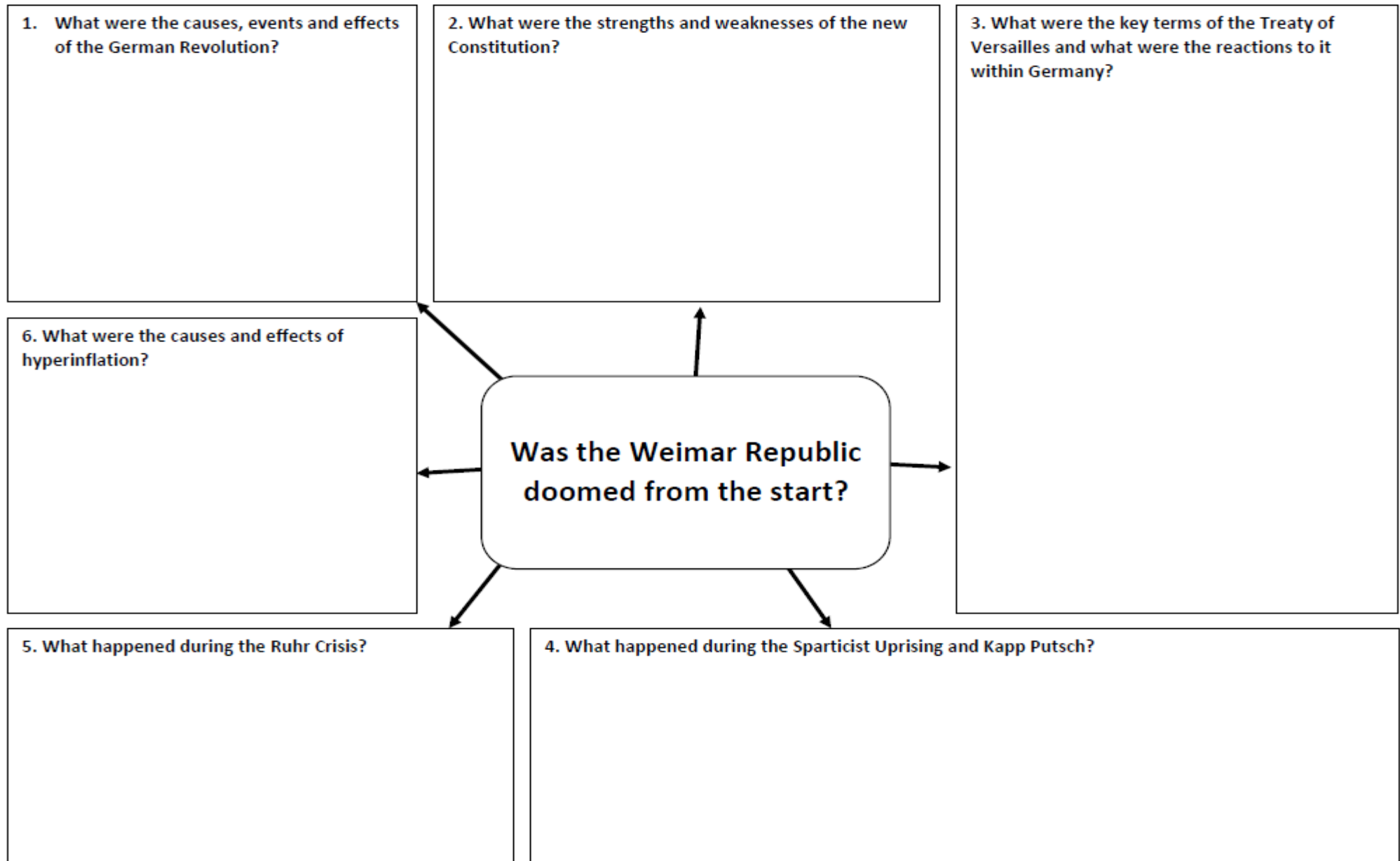
IGCSE/GCSE Revision Checklist: Germany 1918-45

Use this revision checklist to help you keep track of all the topics you need to revise for your exam. You need to have a confident grasp of the subject knowledge about each event. Try revising facts and key features about each event and recalling the key points and details on paper. Try to answer at least one exam question for each event. When you feel confident enough, progress onto the next event.

Event	You should be able to:	Checklist
The 1918 German Revolution	- Describe the causes, events and results of the 1918 Revolution. - Describe who the 'November Criminals' were.	☐
The Weimar Constitution Aug 1919	- Describe the key terms of the Weimar Constitution. - Describe the strengths & weaknesses of the Weimar Constitution.	☐
The Treaty of Versailles Jun 1919	- Describe the key terms of the Treaty of Versailles. - Describe the reactions of the German people to the Treaty of Versailles.	☐
The Spartacist Uprising Jan 1919	Describe the causes, events and effects of the Spartacist Uprising.	☐
The Kapp Putsch Mar 1920	Describe the causes, events and effects of the Kapp Putsch.	☐
The Ruhr Crisis 1923	Describe the causes, events and results of the Ruhr Crisis.	☐
Hyperinflation 1923	- Describe what hyperinflation is. - Describe how hyperinflation effected the economy.	☐
Recovery of the Economy	Describe how the Rentenmark, Dawes and Young Plans improved the German economy.	☐
Successes in Foreign Policy	- Describe how the Locarno Treaties, German entry to the League of Nations and the Kellogg-Brian Pact improved Germany's image abroad. - Describe how significant Stresemann was in helping Germany to recover.	☐
Hitler and the early Nazis Party 1919-1923	- Describe Hitler's early life before joining the DAP. - Describe the changes Hitler made to the early Nazi Party.	☐
The Munich Putsch 1923	Describe the causes, events and effects of the Munich Putsch.	☐
Reorganisation of the Nazi Party 1924-1928	- Describe how and why the Nazi Party was reorganised in 1924-1928. - Describe why the NSDAP was still unsuccessful by 1928.	☐
Impact of the Wall Street Crash 1929	- Describe the cause, events and effects of the Wall Street Crash on Germany. - Describe what the Government tried to do to solve it.	☐
How did the NSDAP become the biggest Party in Germany?	- Describe the methods used by the Nazis to win support. - Describe the role of Goebbels in winning support. - Describe who voted Nazi and why. - Describe the main reasons why Nazi support grew.	☐

Why was Hitler appointed Chancellor?	- Describe why parliamentary democracy declined 1930-32. - Describe the events of 1932 to Jan 1933, including the role of Von Papen, Von Schleicher and President Hindenburg.	☐
Reichstag Fire Feb 1933	Describe the causes, events and effects of the Reichstag Fire.	☐
Enabling Act March 1933	- Describe how Hitler managed to pass the Enabling Act. - Describe how the Enabling Act changed the Constitution. - Describe how Hitler used the Enabling Act to consolidate his power.	☐
The Night of the Long Knives June 1933	- Describe the causes, events and effects of the Night of the Long Knives. - Describe how Hitler consolidated power further after the death of President Hindenburg.	☐
The Police State 1933-1939	- Describe the role of the SS in maintaining control. - Describe the role of the Gestapo in maintaining control. - Describe the role of Prison Camps in maintaining control. - Describe the role of the Law Courts in maintaining control.	☐
Censorship and Propaganda 1933-1939	- Describe how censorship was used to restrict and ban information. - Describe how propaganda was used to publicise information. - Describe the significance of Joseph Goebbels in overseeing and spreading Nazi propaganda.	☐
Nazi policies towards the Churches 1933-1939	- Describe the successes and failures of Hitler's attempt to control the Catholic Church. - Describe the successes and failures of Hitler's attempts to control the Protestant Churches.	☐
Nazi policies towards Young People 1933-1939	- Describe how the Nazis tried to control Young People through Youth Movements. - Describe how the Nazis tried to control Young People through Education.	☐
Nazi policies towards Women 1933-1939	- Describe attitudes towards women in the 1920s. - Describe Nazi attitudes and policies towards women. - Describe how Nazi attitudes towards women changed during World War Two.	☐
Nazi policies towards the economy 1933-1939	- Describe how the Nazis solved the unemployment problem. - Describe how Nazis policies were used to control workers. - Describe the process of German rearmament in the 1930s.	☐
Nazi policies towards the Jews 1933-1939	- Describe the extent of Anti-Semitism in Germany before Hitler. - Describe Hitler's views on the Jews including <i>Mein Kampf</i>. - Describe how Hitler persecuted the Jews from 1933-1939.	☐
War and the Final Solution 1939-1945	- Describe the role of Ghettos in persecuting Jews. - Describe the role of Concentration Camps in persecuting Jews. - Describe the role of the Einsatzgruppen in persecuting the Jews. - Describe what the Final Solution was and why it was decided. - Describe the role of Death Camps in persecuting the Jews.	☐
Opposition to Hitler 1939-1945	- Describe the extent of political opposition to Hitler during the war. - Describe how the White Rose Group opposed Hitler. - Describe how the Edelweiss Pirates opposed Hitler. - Describe the extent of religious opposition to Hitler during the war. - Describe the extent of opposition from the military to Hitler. - Describe why opposition increased during the War.	☐
Defeat and Death of Hitler 1939-1945	- Describe how the Nazi regime was defeated during World War Two. - What was the key turning point in World War Two? - How, when and where did Hitler finally die?	☐

IGCSE/GCSE Revision Diagrams: Germany 1918-1945



1. How did Stresemann solve the hyperinflation crisis?

2. How did the Dawes Plan improve the German economy?

6. How did signing the Kellogg-Briand Pact improve Germany's image in the world?

**How did Germany recover
under Stresemann?**

3. How did the Young Plan improve the German economy?

5. How did signing the Locarno Treaty improve Germany's image in the world?

4. In what ways did German entry to the League of Nations improve Germany?

1. How did Hitler change the early Nazi Party 1919-1922?

2. What were the causes, events and results of the Munich Putsch?

3. How was the Nazi Party reorganised in the years 1924-1928?

6. How did the events of 1932-1933 lead to Hitler being appointed Chancellor?

**How and why did
Hitler become
Chancellor in 1933?**

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graph TD; A[How and why did Hitler become Chancellor in 1933?] --> B[1. How did Hitler change the early Nazi Party 1919-1922?]; A --> C[2. What were the causes, events and results of the Munich Putsch?]; A --> D[3. How was the Nazi Party reorganised in the years 1924-1928?]; A --> E[4. What was the impact of the Wall Street Crash?]; A --> F[5. What methods did the Nazi's use to win support between 1929-1933?]; A --> G[6. How did the events of 1932-1933 lead to Hitler being appointed Chancellor?];
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5. What methods did the Nazi's use to win support between 1929-1933?

4. What was the impact of the Wall Street Crash?

1. How did the Reichstag Fire and Enabling Act help Hitler to consolidate power?

2. What were the causes, events and effects of the Night of the Long Knives?

3. How was the Police State used to consolidate Nazi control over Germany?

8. What were Nazi policies towards the Jews and minorities 1933-1939?

4. How was censorship and propaganda used to consolidate Nazi control?

What was life like in Nazi Germany?

7. What were Nazi policies towards unemployment and the economy?

6. What were Nazi policies towards the Church?

5. What were Nazi policies towards women and young people?

1. How did Nazi policies towards the Jews change during the war?

2. How did the role of women change during the war?

5. How was Hitler finally defeated?

3. How was the German economy and society effected by the war?

**How did Germany
change during the
Second World War?**

4. How and why did opposition to Hitler grow throughout the war?